

**The Year 9
decision most
parents make
by accident.**

Set placement in Year 9 shapes Year 12

The tier a child is entered for narrows what they can take at A Level. That decision is often made on one year of marks, quietly, by a timetable.

Foundation tier caps the grade

Many parents do not realise the ceiling exists until results day. Ask which tier your child is on track for, and ask now, not in Year 11.

Movement between sets is possible but rare

Schools will move a child up if the evidence is loud. That means closing gaps early enough for the evidence to exist.

The window is roughly eighteen months

From the start of Year 9 to the tier decision. Long enough to change the outcome, short enough that drifting through it costs you.



**Send this to a parent
with a child in Year 9.**

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